

SPRINT CAPACITY PLANNING

Plan Realistically. Deliver Predictably.

Scenario: During planning for a 3-week sprint, the team wanted to commit to 35–40 Story Points. We calculate our exact capacity to ensure we commit realistically and deliver sustainably.

What is Capacity? Capacity is the total number of productive hours available for a Scrum team to develop or implement user stories. It is strictly measured in man-hours / person-hours.

1. Resource Consideration Matrix

Only team members directly involved in development or implementation are considered for capacity calculations.

INCLUDED (Development Team)

Developers	4 Resources
QA Engineer	1 Resource
DevOps Engineer	1 Resource

EXCLUDED (Not in Capacity)

Product Owner (PO)	Excluded
Scrum Master (SM)	Excluded
Business Analyst (BA)	Excluded
Solution Architect (SA)	Excluded

2. Sprint Parameters & Availability

Sprint Detail / Parameter	Value / Duration
Sprint Duration	3 Weeks
Standard Working Days in Sprint	15 Days
Planned Leaves	-3 Days
Optional & Mandatory Holidays	0 Days
Available Working Days	12 Days (15 Days - 3 Leaves)

3. Daily Productive Hours Breakdown (Per Person)

Particulars	Hours / Day	Total Hours for 12 Days
Total Working Hours	8.0 Hours	96.0 Hours
Break Time	-1.0 Hours	-12.0 Hours
Scrum Events / Meetings (Daily Scrum, Planning, Review, Retro, Grooming, etc.)	-1.0 Hours	-12.0 Hours
Productive Hours Remaining	6.0 Hours	72.0 Hours

4. Team Capacity Accumulation

Role	No. of Resources	Productive Hours (Per Person)	Total Capacity (Hours)
Developers	4	72 Hours	288 Hours
QA Engineer	1	72 Hours	72 Hours
DevOps Engineer	1	72 Hours	72 Hours
TOTAL ACTUAL CAPACITY			432 Hours

5. Final Team Capacity with Focus Factor

We apply a **Focus Factor (80% – 85%)** to safeguard commitments against real-world complexities such as unplanned leaves, agile volatility, unknown risks/dependencies, or urgent production support.

Selected Focus Factor: **85%**

Calculation: **432 Actual Hours × 85% Focus Factor**

FINAL TEAM CAPACITY: **367.2 ≈ 367 Hours**

The Strategic Result

Realistic Commitment

Prevents overpromising data.

Reduced Spillovers

Boosts delivery predictability.

Sustainable Pace

Protects team health & flow.

Stakeholder Trust

Improves outward confidence.



KEY TAKEAWAY: Plan with real capacity, not just generic available hours. Better planning yields better outcomes!